

Rewind – "The Film Journal" Design Doc

Core Aesthetic

Warm scrapbook meets cinema lover's notebook. Cream backgrounds, polaroid-style poster cards, handwritten touches, and film artifacts (ticket stubs, stamps, film strip accents). It should feel like a cinephile's personal journal – not a productivity tool, not a craft project. The warmth comes from color and texture; the cinema grounding keeps it from drifting into Pinterest territory.

App Structure

Same two states, same three tabs, same rules as every direction.

LOGGED OUT:

```
+-----+
|  Landing page (scattered polaroids + auth card)  |
+-----+
```

LOGGED IN:

```
+-----+
|  Navbar:   [ Home ]   [ Discover ]   [ Watchlist ]   |
|                                                    |
|  Home      = Your backlog (masonry layout)         |
|  Discover  = TMDB search + trending defaults       |
|  Watchlist = Completed items from your backlog     |
+-----+
```

Universal Interaction Rules

Every poster card across the app behaves consistently:

Interaction	Behavior
Click poster	Opens Media Detail page (always, on every page)
Poster hover	Gentle lift + shadow deepen + shows action buttons

Item states and what you can do with them:


```

|           |tape|           '-----+-----'           |tape|           |
|
|           |tape|           |
|
|           +-----+-----+
|           |           |
|           |   R E W I N D   |
|           |   Press play on   |
|           |   the past.       |
|           |           |
|           +-----+-----+
|           ^^ notecard, pinned ^^
|
|   .------.   .------.   .------.
|   /  poster  \   /  poster  \   /  poster  \
|   |  (tilt   |   |  (tilt   |   |  (tilt   |
|   |   +5deg) |   |   -2deg) |   |   -4deg) |
|   '-----+'   '-----+'   '-----+'
|           |tape|           |tape|           |tape|
|
|   ~~~ warm linen background, subtle paper texture ~~~
+-----+

```

Scattered Polaroids (Background)

Trending movie/TV posters displayed as polaroids scattered across the page.

- **8-12 polaroids** arranged at various rotations (`transform: rotate(-5deg)` to `rotate(+5deg)`)
- Each has the white polaroid border (thick bottom for a caption area), subtle drop shadow
- **Tape marks:** small rectangles at the top of each polaroid, slightly rotated, as if taped to a wall
- Positions are fixed but feel organic — placed to frame the center notecard without overlapping it
- **Subtle float animation:** each polaroid gently drifts 2-3px up and down on a slow offset loop (8-12s). Not synchronized — staggered start times so they breathe independently
- **On hover:** a polaroid lifts slightly and its shadow deepens, like picking it up off a table

Data: `GET /tmdb/trending` — fetch ~12 posters, assign each a random-ish rotation and position.

CSS: Absolute positioning within a relative container. `transform: rotate()` per item. Float via `@keyframes translateY`, each with a different `animation-delay`.

Brand Notecard

Centered over the scattered polaroids:

- Styled as a physical notecard — off-white (#f5f0e8), subtle border, very slight rotation (1–2deg)
- Pinned to the background with a small colored circle (pushpin) at the top center
- **"REWIND"** — serif font, 2rem, warm brown (#3d2c1e), letter-spacing 0.2em
- **"Press play on the past."** — 0.95rem, muted warm gray, italic

Auth Buttons & Modals

Top-right: **Log In** (outlined, warm brown) and **Sign Up** (solid terracotta).

```
+-----+
|           Log In           [ x ] |
|                               |
| Username  .------. |
|           | ~~~~~~ | |
|           '-----' |
| Password  .------. |
|           | ~~~~~~ | |
|           '-----' |
|                               |
|           [ Log In  ~~button~~ ] |
|                               |
| Don't have an account? Sign up |
|                               |
+-----+

warm card (#fdf9f3), soft shadow
inputs have warm-gray underline style
(no hard borders, just bottom line)
```

- Warm card background (#fdf9f3), generous padding, rounded corners
- Inputs styled with **bottom-line only** — warm gray, darkens on focus
- Buttons are rounded, terracotta fill, cream text
- Bottom link toggles between Log In <-> Sign Up modals
- Polaroids stay visible and floating behind the dimmed backdrop

Home (Your Backlog)

The main logged-in screen. Your journal of saved movies and shows. The layout is a masonry grid — polaroid cards at slightly varied sizes, like photos arranged in a scrapbook. The "From the Back Pages" section replaces cinematic-techy's Rediscover hero with a gentler, journal-entry styled prompt.

Layout

```

+-----+
| REWIND      [ Home ]   [ Discover ]   [ Watchlist ]           [me] [=>]|
+-----+
|
|
| +-----+
| | .-----.|
| | | poster | FROM THE BACK PAGES
| | | (small |
| | | tilted)| "The Thing You Forgot About"
| | '-----' Sci-Fi * 2019 * Saved 8 months ago
| |
| |
| | [ Watched It ] [ Remove ]
| +-----+
|
|    ^^ styled like a torn-out notebook page ^^
|
|
| My Backlog
|
| .-----. .-----.
| | Sort:   v | | Genre: v |
| | '-----' | '-----'
|
|
| .-----. .-----. .-----.
| | poster  | | poster  | | poster  |
| | (wide)  | | (tall)  | |          |
| |          | |          | |          |
| +-----+ | |          | +-----+
| | Title   | |          | | Title   |
| | Saved   | +-----+ | Saved   |
| | Mar 4    | | Title    | | Jan 12  |
| | '-----' | Saved Nov 1 | | '-----'
| |          | '-----'
|
| .-----. .-----. .-----.
| | poster  | | poster  | | poster  |
| |          | |          | | (wide)  |
| |          | |          | |          |
| |          | +-----+ +-----+

```

```

| +-----+ | Title | | Title | | |
| | Title | | Saved | | Saved |
| | Saved Feb 20 | | Dec 8 | | Oct 15 |
| '-----' '-----' '-----'
|
| (... masonry continues ...)
|
| Empty state:
| "Your journal is blank. Head to Discover and start collecting."
+-----+

```

From the Back Pages (Journal Entry)

- Shows the **oldest item** in your backlog (earliest `date_added`)
- Styled as a torn notebook page — off-white background, faint ruled lines, slightly rough edges (CSS `clip-path` or box-shadow trick)
- Small tilted poster on the left, text on the right
- Serif title, warm metadata line with how long ago it was saved
- Two rounded buttons: **Watched It** (sage green) and **Remove** (muted warm gray)
- Feels like a gentle nudge, not a loud hero banner

Masonry Backlog Grid

- **Masonry layout** — cards at varying heights based on poster aspect ratio
- Each card is a polaroid: white border, caption area below with title + "Saved [date]"
- Slight rotation on alternating cards (`-1deg` , `+1.5deg` , `-0.5deg`) — subtle enough to feel organic, not chaotic
- **Default order: randomized on every page load** (client-side shuffle)
- **Sort dropdown:** "Random" (default), "Earliest Saved", "Latest Saved"
- **Genre filter dropdown:** populated from genres in user's backlog
- Desktop: 3-column masonry. Mobile: 2-column

Poster Hover (Home Grid)

```

.-----
| poster |
|         |
| [Done] [ x ] | <-- appears on hover
+-----+
| Title |
| Saved Mar 4 |

```

'-----'

card lifts, shadow deepens

- [Done]= sage green stamp, marks completed, moves to Watchlist
- [x]= muted, removes from backlog
- Whole card lifts 4px and shadow softens/grows on hover

Backlog Features Summary

Feature	How it works
Add movie/show	From Discover page -> bookmark toggle
Remove movie/show	Hover[x] on Home grid, or Discover toggle, or detail view
Genre filter	Dropdown filters the masonry grid by genre
Randomized display	Client-side shuffle on load, "Random" sort option
Sort earliest/latest	Sort dropdown changes grid order by <code>date_added</code>
Mark completed	Hover[Done] on Home grid, or Back Pages button -> moves to Watchlist

Discover (Search + Trending)

```
+-----+
| REWIND      [ Home ]  [ Discover ]  [ Watchlist ]           [me] [=>] |
+-----+
|
| .-----. |
| | /  Search your next favorite... | |
| '-----' |
|   ^^ rounded, warm cream input, pencil icon ^^ |
|
| ( All ) ( Action ) ( Comedy ) ( Drama ) ( Sci-Fi ) ( Horror ) |
| ~~~~~ ~warm pill chips, terracotta when active~ |
|
| Trending Right Now                (shown when search bar is empty) |
| ~~~ handwritten-style section header ~~~ |
|
| .-----. .-----. .-----. .-----. |
| | poster  | | poster  | | poster  | | poster  | |
| |         | |         | | +-----+ | |         | |
| |         | |         | |         | |         | |
```

```
| | | | | saved | | | | |
| | | | | +-----+ | | | | |
| +-----+ +-----+ +-----+ +-----+ |
| | Title | | Title | | Title | | Title | |
| | 2024 | | 2023 | | 2024 | | 2024 | |
| | '-----' | | '-----' | | '-----' | |
|
|
| (... 20-30 items default, more on search ...)
+-----+
```

- **Default state (empty search bar):** top 20-30 trending from TMDB
- **Search:** queries TMDB by title, replaces trending grid with results
- **Genre chips:** warm rounded pills – cream default, terracotta fill when active
- **Grid:** uniform polaroid cards here (not masonry – cleaner for browsing unfamiliar content)
- **Status badges on posters:**
 - Not saved -> no badge, hover shows [+ Save]
 - In backlog -> small bookmark ribbon badge (top-right corner), hover shows [x Remove]
 - Completed -> muted card + "Watched" stamp overlay, hover shows [Undo] or [x Remove]
- Save toggle: clicking the badge adds/removes from backlog without navigating away
- Clicking a card (not the badge) opens the **Media Detail Page**

Bookmark Ribbon Badge

```
| |
| /
|/ <-- small folded ribbon, terracotta
.-----+-----
| poster |
```

A small folded ribbon in the top-right corner of saved posters. Terracotta colored. Visual bookmark – fits the journal metaphor without being a generic checkmark.

Watchlist (Completed Items)

```
+-----+
| REWIND [ Home ] [ Discover ] [ Watchlist ] [me] [=>] |
+-----+
|
| Watchlist "22 films watched"
| ^ ^ handwritten style ^ ^
|
```



```
| | | | this film... | |
| | '-----' | |
| | | | | |
| | States: | |
| | - Not saved: [ + Add to Backlog ] | |
| | - In backlog: [ Watched It ] [ Remove ] | |
| | - Completed: [ Back to Backlog ] [ Remove ] | |
| | | | | |
| +-----+ |
|      ^^ warm card, like an open journal page ^^ |
+-----+
```

- **No full-bleed backdrop** – this direction doesn't do the IMAX thing
- Instead: a warm card container styled like a journal page (off-white, faint ruled lines, soft shadow)
- Large poster with polaroid border on the left, all text on the right
- Title in serif, metadata line with dot separators
- Description in clean body font, warm and readable
- Action buttons match the state logic – rounded, warm colors (terracotta for primary, warm gray for destructive)
- Feels like reading someone's journal entry about this film

Typography & Color

Token	Value
Title font	Playfair Display – serif, warm, cinematic without being stuffy
Body font	Nunito – rounded sans-serif, friendly and readable
Hero/page titles	2rem, Playfair Display, bold
Section headers	1.25rem, Playfair Display, semibold
Body text	0.875–1rem, Nunito, regular
Background	#faf6f0 (warm cream)
Surface/cards	#fdf9f3 (slightly lighter cream)
Journal pages	#f5f0e8 (off-white with warmth)
Primary text	#3d2c1e (warm dark brown)
Secondary text	#8a7b6b (warm gray)
Borders	#e8dfd4 (warm light gray)

Token	Value
Accent (primary)	#c4603c (terracotta)
Accent (secondary)	#7a9e7e (sage green – for success/completed actions)
Accent (highlight)	#d4a853 (ochre – for stars, badges, special moments)
Polaroid border	#ffffff with box-shadow: 0 2px 8px rgba(61,44,30,0.12)

The Warm Stack

Cream base (#faf6f0)

```
|
+-- Cards float on top as off-white journal pages
|
+-- Terracotta for CTAs and active states
|
+-- Sage for "completed" / positive actions
|
+-- Warm brown text throughout (never pure black)
|
+-- Shadows are always warm-tinted, never cool gray
```

Implementation Notes

CSS-only baseline: warm color palette via CSS custom properties, masonry via `column-count` (3 desktop, 2 mobile), polaroid borders via padding + box-shadow, rotations via `transform: rotate()`, paper textures via subtle CSS gradients or a single tiling background image.

Key CSS patterns:

- Polaroid card: `padding: 4px 4px 40px; background: white; box-shadow: warm; transform: rotate(Xdeg)`
- Rubber stamp: `border: 3px solid terracotta; transform: rotate(-8deg); opacity: 0.7; font-weight: bold`
- Notebook ruled lines: `background: repeating-linear-gradient(transparent, transparent 27px, #e8dfd4 28px)`
- Torn page edge: `clip-path` with slight irregularity, or jagged `box-shadow`
- Bookmark ribbon: CSS triangle with `::before` pseudo-element

Optional stretch libraries:

- **Framer Motion** — page transitions, card entrance stagger
- **Masonry layout lib** (e.g., react-masonry-css) — if `column-count` CSS masonry isn't sufficient
- **Google Fonts** — Playfair Display + Nunito (both free, well-supported)